Kenny Chirombo

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Backend Engineer

Summary

Developer experienced in building and maintaining backend services, web applications, and serverless APIs with AWS Lambda and AWS API Gateway. Background includes Python development, running performance benchmarks, maintaining high availability and security, and creating CI/CD pipelines for deployment.

Skills

Backend Development, C#, Dot Net, Python, Serverless, AWS, AWS API Gateway, AWS Lambda, Cloud Architecture, Containerization, CI/CD, Performance Benchmarking, Monitoring, Security, SRE, Web Development, Software Development, Project Management

Experience

Technical Lead, Dreamverse Holdings

Jan 2024 – Present | Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Built web and mobile apps for clients, ran performance benchmarks, maintained high availability and security, and created CI/CD pipelines for building and deploying web applications.
- Developed and deployed AI and machine learning models at scale for production workloads, tracking performance and maintaining ML pipelines for real-time applications.
- Integrated large language models (LLMs) and machine learning algorithms into production systems, optimizing models for real-time deployment to improve client decision-making.

Volunteer Software Developer, Wikimedia

Oct 2023 – Present | Remote

- Developed and maintained backend services and features for operational quality, focusing on Anti-Harassment tools to support a safe user environment.
- Migrated machine-generated article description inference services from Toolforge to Liftwing to maintain smooth and efficient operation.
- Improved Istio mesh traffic transparent proxy capabilities for external domains accessed by Lift Wing, increasing service connectivity and performance.
- Contributed to the Anti-Harassment, Machine Learning, and Data-Platform-SRE teams.
- Completed operations and engineering backlog tasks across multiple Data Platforms teams, including the Machine Learning team building services for Wikimedia sites.

Research Associate: Python Developer, UJ PEETS

Jan 2021 – Dec 2023 | Johannesburg, Gauteng

- Designed a Python GUI Decision Support System for risk-based water quality guidelines, improving user accessibility and interaction.
- Used SageMaker to implement and maintain CI/CD/CT workflows for machine learning models.
- Led and contributed to research projects for multiple clients.

Full Stack Developer, Penyesa SA

Dec 2018 – Dec 2020 | Sandton, Gauteng

- Integrated a serverless API with AWS API Gateway and AWS services.
- Scripted AWS Lambda functions to serve as the backend.

- Worked with cloud architectures, containerization, application deployment, alerting, monitoring, and automation.

Education

Electrical and Electronics Engineering (BEng studies; incomplete), University of Johannesburg (2017–2018)

Certifications

AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner (expired), Amazon Web Services (2018)